11. Self-Evaluation: "Can a vendor build this?"

> AdmitAssist | MBA ZG583 Management of AI Products | GOLLAPUDI SIVA NAGA JNANA TEJA | 2025MB26205 | GitHub: jnanateja009

The faculty's instruction: give the PM artifacts to an AI and ask two things, (1) build the product, and (2) do a self-evaluation: feedback, ambiguity, changes, hard-coded vs configurable. In class he added: ask first "Do you need any clarifications before you can build it?", and treat the documents as a contract you are paying Rs 1 crore for.

1. How I ran it

Step	What happened
Build	The working prototype was built by an AI assistant from the PRD and design rules (10, section 1). Building it was itself a test of the documents: it exposed the gaps listed in 10, section 3 (rows 1 to 12), before the review.
Review 1	A separate AI session, given only the documents, diagrams and settings file (no code), acting as a vendor asked to quote a fixed price. Prompt in section 2.
Fix	I went through every finding. Section 3 lists each one and what I did.
Review 2	A second separate session checked whether the findings were closed and whether the fixes created new problems (section 5).
Wording check	`tools/wording_check.py` scans every document for the vague and banned words the faculty listed ("accurate", "user", "customer", "reduction", ...).

Final wording-check run: 24 flags, all kept on purpose. They are defined terms ("fast approval" means under 10 seconds; "high risk" means a score of 10 or more), other companies' own wording (Yellow.ai's "customer experience"), the API's role name "user", the course option title "improve a real workflow", and the faculty's word list quoted in this document.

2. The review prompt (verbatim)

```
You are an experienced engineering vendor and AI product reviewer. A client has sent you their product documents
    for
"AdmitAssist" and is willing to pay a fixed price (think Rs 1 crore) for you to build V1 exactly from these
    documents.
Any ambiguity you accept now becomes a dispute later, so be strict.
Read ONLY the files in [review folder]. Do not look at any other folder; there is a code prototype elsewhere but
    you
must judge the documents alone.
The faculty who set this assignment asked for exactly two things. Do both.
TASK 1 - "Can you build this?" Before building, list every clarification you would need. For each: the document
    and
section, the exact ambiguity or gap, why it blocks or risks the build, and a concrete suggested resolution. Then
    give a
verdict: could you build V1 from these documents as they stand (yes / yes with these clarifications / no), and a
readiness score from 1 to 10.
TASK 2 - Self-evaluation. Give feedback on: (a) any remaining vague words or targets without numbers; (b)
inconsistencies between documents (numbers, dates, versions, names, prices, thresholds) - check the arithmetic
    where
you can; (c) what is hard-coded vs configurable, and whether any hard-coded item should be configurable or vice
    versa;
(d) anything that is missing for an AI product specifically (evaluation, uncertainty, fallback, cost, human
    review,
data protection); (e) the three changes that would most improve the documents.
Rules: be specific (quote the text you object to), rank items by severity (Blocker / Major / Minor), do not pad
    with
praise, keep the whole report under 1,800 words.
```

3. Review 1: verdict and what I changed

Verdict: "Yes, with these clarifications". Readiness 6 out of 10. 5 Blocker, 20 Major, 24 Minor. The reviewer also checked the arithmetic and confirmed the RICE scores, the unit-economics tables, the yearly price, the cash budget, the reply-by examples and the confidence intervals.

3.1 Blockers

#	Finding (short)	What I did	Where
B1	What V1 delivers is undefined: one school or several, metering, invoicing, technology, hosting, who operates it	Wrote the build contract annex: multi-school (up to 10), monthly usage CSV, invoices by hand, fixed technology list, India-region VM, I operate; 36 hours broken down	03b section 1
B2	Tests, sample data and label format live in the prototype, outside the documents	Prototype files declared exhibits with SHA-256 checksums; the prototype is the reference implementation and starting code	03b section 2
B3	Acceptance depends on Gate A, which no vendor can promise at a fixed price	Split software acceptance (repeatable tests on recorded AI responses) from AI gates (product owner's go / no-go, 40-hour tuning cap)	03b section 3
B4	No prompt template; read_v1 vs read_v1.1 unclear	Templates with placeholders printed in full; read_v1 binding; read_v1.1 is a change request due before 2 Apr 2027	03b section 4
B5	Permissions conflict between 03 and 08; only 2 logins	One permissions table, one login per person, propose / approve flow, staff-only alert	03b section 5; 03 section 4; 08 section 7

3.2 Major

#	Finding	What I did	Where
M1	When does the reply clock stop for staff-only cases; repeat messages	Clock-stop event per route; required closing note; 14-day threading by mobile number	03b section 6; FR-26; app
M2	No behaviour when the draft call fails after a good read	"Draft unavailable: write your own reply"	03b section 7
M3	WhatsApp link with no phone, two phones, landline, e-mail	Number picker, copy-only, "Open e-mail"	03b section 7; FR-19; app
M4	Office landline masked as a parent's mobile; STD landlines not masked	Office number allow-listed as [OFFICE_PHONE]; landlines and foreign numbers masked; known limit stated	Engine 1.1.0; 03b section 8; 3 tests
M5	Does a failed quote cancel a staff-only route?	No. A sensitive flag always stands.	FR-08
M6	Draft-check rules incomplete ("Rs 500", "25k", "15th June", 8:30 AM fact)	Full rule list; engine checks short-form and small Rs amounts and day-month dates	Engine 1.1.0; 03b section 9; 4 tests
M7	Seats per session; timeframe overlap from April; closed classes	Seat status applies to next session; closed = 0 points and shown; timeframe precedence in read_v1.1	Engine 1.1.0; 03b section 10; 1 test
M8	"Turn off drafting" switch did not exist	`reply.drafting_enabled`	Engine; FR-25; 03b section 11
M9	36 P1 hours vs 4.7 person-weeks of features	RICE efforts are for building from nothing; P1 starts from the prototype; hours itemised (52 after review 2)	03b section 1

#	Finding	What I did	Where
M10	V1 promises deletion within 7 days but 07 put it in V2; paid use crosses 13 May 2027	Deletion, export, retention, notice in V1; consent for children's health data by 30 Apr 2027	03b section 12; 07
M11	Labelling guide copied the scoring rules (circular)	Human labelling guide with examples	05 section 2.2
X1	AI cost per inquiry differed across documents	Rs 0.36 planning figure and Rs 0.32 measured, everywhere, both labelled	01, 02, 04, diagrams
X2	Retention rules inconsistent; backups outlive deletion	One rule: text 180 days, log rows 2 years, backups 30 days	NFR-05; 03b section 12; 08
X3	Gate blockers listed differently in 05 and 08	Gate B uses the full list in 08 section 6; name-swap (M17) is a Gate A blocker in 05	05 section 6.4
X4	60 sensitive messages prove 94.0%, not 95%	Sensitive set raised to 75 (95.1%), at least 15 real	05, 01, 08
X5	Masking, the "AI can only raise" rule and the LOW rule could be switched off in settings	Locked: settings check rejects other values; retention limited to 30-365 days	Engine 1.1.0; 03 section 7; 1 test
X6	Draft checks measure rule-breaking, not correctness	M14: principal reviews 50 drafts, target 90% need no factual correction	05
X7	Self-rated confidence never checked; temperature makes name-swap unstable	M15 calibration, M16 stability (3 runs), M17 name-swap at temperature 0	05; 08 section 5
X8	Fallback model untested; model versions not pinned	Fallback used only if it passes the Gate A blockers; dated snapshots; model name stored on every result	05 section 4
X9	Children's health and custody details go to the AI provider; cross-border; backups	Stated as a known exposure with controls; provider's shortest retention; regional endpoint option at +10% (Rs 0.40 per inquiry)	08 section 4.2

3.3 Minor (24), grouped

Group	What I did
Undefined small terms (closest class, year detection, low confidence, other languages, text normalisation)	Defined in 03b section 13
Queue wording ("top of the queue") vs sorting	FR-07 reworded
Holidays, PIN lockout	`school.holidays` (reply-by skips them, test added); lockout 5 tries / 15 min
Cap per school vs per browser	Stated: prototype per browser, pilot per school
"Setup takes one hour" vs 3 h + visit	Both stated: about 1 hour of the school's time, 3 hours plus a visit of mine
"well enough to test"	Replaced with the measured result and the Gate A metric
Support evenings, "my API tier", access-log trigger	Exact hours; "limit of my API usage tier"; new-device and out-of-hours logins checked weekly
FR-11 example wrong (INQ-004 has no visit)	Corrected to the real quotes, score 7
Version labels	Engine 1.1.1 and documents 1.1 everywhere
3.6 vs 3.5 minutes	Calculator uses 3.6 (40% less); time saved now 8.0 h = Rs 769
"about 600" pilot inquiries	About 460
Quiet months "near break-even"	Reworded: Rs 212 contribution on purpose

Group	What I did
Support margin at 1 hour	Added to the stress test (58%)
R-01 scored 8 but called the worst failure	Likelihood raised to 3; score 12, high risk
Browser versions	Current and previous major version, in 03 and 09
Hard-coded items that should be settings (country code, greeting, years, 10-second limit, 80% quote share)	All moved to settings; years derived from the session dates
FR-23 re-run cost	About Rs 60 per run (05 section 4)
T3 had no way to be recorded	"Report a problem with this reply" (FR-27)

4. Hard-coded vs configurable, after the changes

Kind	Items
Settings (change without code)	School facts, classes, aliases, seats, fees and fee disclosure, documents, approved facts, session dates, holidays, priority points and thresholds, 60-day window, keyword lists, reply-by targets, confidence cut-offs, quote match share, word limit, blocked phrases, greeting, country code, retries, drafting on/off, fast-approval limit, model names, fallback, prices, exchange rate, monthly AI cap, retention (30-365 days)
Shown in settings but locked	Masking before the AI (always on); AI can only raise priority; LOW only at HIGH confidence
Fixed in code on purpose	Sensitive-first routing; the tool cannot send; the six signals and four sensitive categories (prompt and labels depend on them); Indian phone formats (V2: country setting)

5. Review 2: after the changes

Second session, same rules, given the revised documents and the first report. Prompt: the same vendor role, asked to mark each earlier Blocker and Major as Closed / Partly closed / Open, list new problems the revisions introduced, and answer again "Could you build this V1 from these documents?".

Verdict: "Yes, with these clarifications". Readiness 8 out of 10 (up from 6). B1 and B4 closed; B2, B3 and B5 partly closed; 14 of the 20 Majors closed. Its words: "After that I would sign."

What it still found, and what I did:

#	Finding	What I did
B2	Exhibit list without checksums	Checksums are stamped into 03b section 2 and `prototype/EXHIBIT_CHECKSUMS.txt` when the folder is packaged
B3	Software acceptance still included speed and uptime, which depend on the model and on a month of running	S4 now covers NFR-04 (code review), 05, 06 and 07 only; speed and cost are Gate A; uptime is measured in operation
B5	"Propose / approve" had no screen and no hours; 03 section 7 still named old approvers	Approval screen specified and costed (4 h); 03 section 7 rewritten as a summary of 03b section 5
N1	`read_v1.1` had four different timings	One date: ships by 15 Mar 2027, before the 2 Apr overlap; shown in 03b, 07 and 10
M9	P1 hours too low	52 hours, itemised; 2 days of leave
M8	08 still said "drafting stops for that category"	The switch is global; 08 reworded
M7, uncertainty	Timeframe overlap and confidence bands depend on `read_v1.1`	Bands fixed to 0.80 / 0.50; ships by 15 Mar 2027
Fallback	Settings held a model family name, not a dated snapshot	Phase 1 switches to dated snapshots (note in settings and 05)

#	Finding	What I did
Sensitive set	Up to 60 of 75 could be my rewordings	At least 40 real, from the whole of last season's WhatsApp history
N2	Typo in the binding template ("{{received.")	Fixed
N3	03 disagreed with the annex on years, 10-digit numbers, phone formats, where the prompt lives	Aligned
N4, N5	09 still said "60+" and "around Rs 0.3"; version labels	Fixed; engine 1.1.1, documents 1.1
N7	State diagram re-read old inquiries; B5 ignored staff-only cases	Diagram and B5 follow the clock-stop rules in 03b section 6
N8	One prompt serves 10 schools but FR-23 used one school's set	FR-23 runs on the combined set (30 labelled messages per school, collected at onboarding)
N9	Drafts repeating the parent's own month ("from December") would be flagged	Engine 1.1.1: months the parent wrote are allowed; dates the parent proposed are still blocked; 2 tests
N10	Node.js 20 is past end of life	Node.js 24 LTS
N11	My cash-payback line compared revenue with cost	Corrected in 07
N12	Unclear how many tests acceptance needs	"All tests pass, plus at least one new test per item in sections 5 to 12 that has none"
Carried	"my API usage tier" not named	"the limit shown for the model on my OpenAI account's Limits page"

I did not run a third review. The remaining risks are the ones only real messages can answer (Phase 0 and Gate A).

6. What I learned from doing this

1. Writing for a vendor is different from writing for a reader. A reader forgives "about 60 messages"; a vendor turns it into a dispute.
2. The AI reviewer was best at cross-document consistency and arithmetic, which is tedious for me and where I had made real mistakes (cost figures, sample size, retention).
3. It could not judge whether my priorities are right for a real school office. That needs the coordinator and real messages (Phase 0).